not, when he ought to recollect that when you give even a Persian muleteer a coat of cloth, if it does not happen to be of the right colour you can hardly hire him to wear it: no people in the world are so fanciful as to their colours and patterns as the Persians. Upon the whole of this investment I think I am justified in anticipating a small profit, because altho some things sell at a loss others have realized very large profits, but in the mean time we are burthened with a large quantity of unsaleable goods, and, worse still, you are loaded with an immense quantity of our debt; if C after leaving Trebizonde had followed my advice, we should not have been so situated. I wished him not to remain in England any longer than was necessary for his business (say two to three months) to bring out a very small investment of what he was sure to leave him from 60 to 100 pr Ct profit; he would then have left you with comparatively a small amount of debt and very probably by this time might have had another investment on its way out. Chintzes are good if properly chosen (ours were none of them suited to the Persian taste and consequently did not sell well) the only way to do well in Chintz and Cotton prints is to go about to the caravanseraies (Public warehouses where the merchants resort) and learn, from observation, what goods are most in demand, obtain patterns, and send them off to England along with money to purchase, there are three or four sorts of prints sold in this market the consumption for which is so great that had I (£10,000 worth) ten thousand pounds worth of *those sorts* I could get rid of them all in a fortnight, for cash, and all to merchants who are so regular in their payments that upon most occasions I have not even to send a servant for the money, the buyer coming himself with the money in his hand.

Dear Mother, as I have now finished the business part of my letter, and since doing so have eaten my lunch, viz a big watermelon, very little less than my head* which cost me about d 1½ English and having smoked my Kaleon (water pipe) it is but just, that I should up a few lines for you; You ask me in one of your letters to give you a description of the country between this and Teheran, I have nothing to describe but rocky mountains and barren plains, in the most barren places you find nothing but here and there a weed more frequently the camel plant of the desert than any other, growing about a foot high and being green until about the end of the month of July but from that time until the 15 April the earth shows scarcely any appearance of green; in the highlands which are generally more fertile the herbage is thicker; but there is nothing like turf except in places which are for five months of the year either flooded or covered with snow. Judge then my feeling when I was in the mountains to the South

* I put the *head* and the *melon* side by side and looked in the glass to <be> sure I might not exagerate [*sic*].

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